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Chapter 5

Utilities



Forecasting Utilities Introduction

The Utilities available within Forecasting maintain or delete an existing Forecasting company and the associated data files.

Maintain Company Profile



1/FCU

This procedure specifies the environment in which the Forecasting application operates. You must set up and maintain a company profile for each company that you use in Forecasting.

This profile controls the working environment by specifying such parameters as:

- The specification of period terminology and backup details to ensure correct security copies of Forecasting.
- Qualification of whether a year contains twelve or thirteen periods.
- The addition and maintenance of forecasting methods.

Maintain Profile Records Selection Screen



Select Maintain Company Profile.

Use this screen to either create a new company profile or maintain an existing one.

The system displays a list of existing Company Codes and descriptions.

FC014	Forecast Company Profile	User SP1	6/09/94 15:16:28
Maintain Profile Records			
Sel	Company		
-	Z1	Demonstration Company	
Enter new company ____			
1=Select			
F3=Exit			

Fields:

Sel

Select. Enter 1 to select the company to be maintained

Enter New Company

Enter the two character code for the company you want to add. This code must not already exist.



If you are adding a new company press **Enter** to display the Maintain Forecast Company Profile - Interface Defaults screen.

If you are maintaining an existing company, the system automatically displays this screen.

Maintain Forecast Company Profile Interface Defaults Screen



To display this screen enter a new company code and press **Enter** on the Maintain Profile Records Selection.



Note: This screen automatically displays when you select an existing company.

Use this screen to maintain details of interfaces to the other active applications. Details found for an existing Forecasting company are displayed.

FC014	Forecast Company Profile	USER SP1	6/09/94 15:16:42
Maintain Forecast Company Profile - Interface Defaults			
Forecast Default Codes			
Interface Company..... <u>Z1</u>			
Note - The company code entered here will be used to access information from the other Business 400 Applications.			
Default FC Model.....?.. <u>C1</u>			
F3=Exit F4=Prompt F8=Update			

Fields:

Interface Company

Enter the code for the Inventory Company whose items are to be extracted for use in this application. This company is also used for the interface with Sales Analysis, Distribution Requirements Planning, and MPS/MRP.

Default FC Model

Enter the default Forecasting Model to be used.



Select **F8=Update** to check the screen and exit. If the system finds any errors it displays an error message at the foot of the screen. Otherwise the details from all five screens are written to the Company Profile and Forecast Methods file.



Note: Before and images are written to the Company Profile Audit File.



Press **Enter** to display the Forecast Company

Profile Maintenance Periods/Backups screen.

Forecast Company Profile Maintenance Periods/Backups Screen



To display this screen press **Enter** on the Forecast Company Profile Interface Defaults screen.

Use this screen to maintain period details and period backup parameters. The backup parameters determine how to make security copies of Forecasting files. The system displays details for an existing Forecasting company.

FC014	Forecast Company Profile	USER SP1	6/09/94 15:16:47
Forecast Company Profile Maintenance - Periods/Backups			
Forecast Start Period			
Company name... <u>Demonstration Company</u>		Number of periods... <u>13</u>	
		Period.. <u>8</u> Year... <u>94</u>	
Period Maintenance - Define period Names. First description corresponds to the first period to be forecast.			
<u>8</u>	<u>9</u>	<u>10</u>	<u>11</u>
<u>12</u>	<u>13</u>	<u>1</u>	<u>2</u>
<u>3</u>	<u>4</u>	<u>5</u>	<u>6</u>
<u>7</u>			
Periodical Backup Required			
<u>0</u>	(1=Yes/0=No)	Device Name.....	
		Tape Density.... <u>1600</u>	
F3=Exit F8=Update F12=Previous			

Fields:

Number Of Periods



Note: This information is linked to Inventory Management's Calendar details and the Sales Analysis Company Profile.



Note: Forecasting can support either 12 or 13 periods per year.

Company Name

Enter the company name using up to 36 alphanumeric characters.

Period

Enter the current period.

Year

Enter the current year.

Period Maintenance

Enter titles for the periods using up to 3 alphanumeric characters. The first one should reflect the current period. These are normally calendar months.

Periodical Backup Required

Enter one of the following:

0 - If the backups are to be controlled outside of this application.

1 - For backups to be initiated automatically at the start of the Period-end Processing Run.



Note: If 1 is selected, the whole of the Forecasting files library is backed up at Period-end.



Note: The Period-end Processing run updates the following:

Period, incremented by one each time.

Year, incremented by one each time.

Period Maintenance, each period title is rolled forward each time.

Device Name

Enter the device name for the Cartridge or Tape Drive you want to use for the backup, using up to 10 alphanumeric characters.

Tape Density

If you want to use a Back Up Tape, enter the tape density. This must be either 1600, 3200, 6250 or 10 000.



Tip: If you select **F8=Update**, all five screens are checked sequentially. If the system finds any errors it displays an error message at the foot of the screen. Otherwise, details from all five screens are written to the Company Profile (and Forecast Methods) files and the application moves on to the Forecast Options screen.



Note: Before and After images are written to the Company Profile Audit File.



Press **Enter** to display the Forecast Company Profile Maintenance Forecast Options screen.

Forecast Company Profile Maintenance Forecast Options Screen



To display this screen press **Enter** on the Forecast Company Profile Maintenance Periods/Backups screen.

Use this screen to maintain miscellaneous options available for the Forecast Period End Processing run.

FC014	Forecast Company Profile	USER SP1	6/09/94 15:16:50
Forecast Company Profile Maintenance - Forecast Options			
Forecast Options			
Activate Conversion Factor..... <u>0</u> (1=Yes, 0=No)			
Purge Forecast History..... <u>12</u>			
Use Seasonal Profiles in Forecast Transfer... <u>1</u> (1=Yes, 0=No)			
F3=Exit F8=Update F12=Previous			

Fields:

Activate Conversion Factor

Enter one of the following:

0 - Not required.

1 - The group and item conversion factors between different units of measure are to be applied to the calculated forecasts and the demand history.

Purge Forecast History

Enter the number of periods that you want forecast history records to be retained before purging them.



Note: The recommended minimum is 12 periods.

Use Seasonal Profiles In Forecast Transfer

Enter one of the following:

0 - Use the existing Spread Profiles defined in Forecasting.

1 - Use the Spread Profiles defined in DRP and/or MRP/MPS.



Tip: If you select **F8=Update**, the remaining screens are checked sequentially. If the system finds any errors it displays an error message at the foot of the screen. Otherwise, details from all five screens are written to the Company Profile and Forecast Methods files.



Note: Before and After images are written to the Company Profile Audit File.



Press **Enter** to display the Forecast Company Profile Maintenance Forecast Methods screen.

Forecast Company Profile Maintenance

Forecast Methods Screen



To display this screen press **Enter** on the Forecast Company Profile Maintenance Forecast Options screen.

Use this screen to maintain descriptions of existing forecast methods, or to add new methods.

FC014	Forecast Company Profile	USER SP1	6/09/94 15:16:52
Forecast Company Profile Maintenance - Forecast Methods			
Forecast Descriptions			
A L3P/3	B L13P/13		
C $(2NPLY + NPYBL) / FACTOR$	D $(2NPLY + NPYBL) / 3$		
E $N3PLY / 3$	F $((N3PLY / L3PLY) * L3P) / 3$		
G EXPONENTIAL SMOOTHING			
F3=Exit F8=Update F12=Previous			

Fields:



Note: To add a new forecast method, a new program must have been written and added to the Period-end Processing Run. Contact your software agent for further details.

Forecast Descriptions

The seven forecast methods (A to G) are displayed together with descriptions of the formulae which they use.

You can amend the descriptions for A to G without affecting the formulae they use. These are shown whenever the forecast methods are prompted.



Note: Forecasting will not move to the Database Options screen if Sales Analysis is not attached.



Tip: Select **F8=Update** and the remaining screens are checked sequentially. If the system finds any errors it displays an error message at the foot of the screen. Otherwise, details from all five screens are written to the Company Profile and Forecast Methods files. Before and After

images are written to the Company Profile Audit file.



Press **Enter** to display the Forecast Company Profile Maintenance Database Options screen.

Forecast Company Profile Maintenance Database Options Screen



To display this screen press **Enter** on the Forecast Company Profile Maintenance Forecast Methods screen.

Use this screen to specify the Sales Analysis fields for Stockroom, Minor Item Group and Quantity to be used by Forecasting. You must complete all three fields.



Note: Forecasting will not display this screen if the Sales Analysis application is not attached.

FC014	Forecast Company Profile	USER SP1	6/09/94 15:16:55
Forecast Company Profile Maintenance - Database Options			
Sales Analysis Stockroom Field.....?.. <u>ATC620</u>			
Sales Analysis Minor Item Group Field...?.. <u>ATP520</u>			
Sales Analysis Quantity Field.....?.. <u>VAL320</u>			
F3=Exit F4=Prompt F8=Update F12=Previous			

Fields:

Sales Analysis Stockroom Field

Enter the Sales Analysis Stockroom field to be used by Forecasting.



Tip: Select the depot field.

Sales Analysis Minor Item Group Field

Enter the Sales Analysis Minor Item Group field to be used by Forecasting.



Tip: Select the Minor Item Group field.

Sales Analysis Quantity Field

Enter the Sales Analysis Quantity field to be used by Forecasting.



Tip: Select the Quantity field.



Select **F8=Update**. The screen is checked. If the system finds any errors it displays an error message at the foot of the screen. Otherwise

details from all five screens are written to the Company Profile and Forecast Methods files. Before and After images are written to the Company Profile Audit file.

Delete a Company



2/FCU



This procedure permanently removes data that is no longer required from the Forecasting application.

Delete Forecast Company Selection Screen

Use this screen to select the Forecasting company that requires deletion.

FC999	Forecasting	USER SP1	6/09/94 15:04:32
Delete Forecast Company - Select			
Select company.....?... _			
 Warning : This will delete all records in Forecasting for the selected company.			
F3=Exit F4=Prompt F8=Submit			

Fields:

Select Company

Select the Forecasting company you want to delete.



***This procedure permanently removes data
that is no longer required from the
Forecasting application.***



Select **F8=Submit** to submit the job to the job
queue.